

[Feature Name] - Spec

Epic: [Link to ProductBoard/Jira Epic] **Date:** YYYY-MM-DD **Status:** Draft | In Review | Approved | Implemented **Team:** [PM name], [Designer name], [Engineer names]

Context & Background

Owner: Product Manager

Instructions: Link to the Epic and summarize key business context. This information should match or be sourced directly from the Epic in ProductBoard/Jira - don't duplicate, just reference and summarize.

- **Epic Link:** [URL to ProductBoard/Jira Epic]
 - **User Problem:** [What problem are we solving? Reference Epic or research]
 - **Business Value:** [Why does this matter? Link to success metrics in Epic]
 - **Research Insights:** [Links to Dovetail research, key findings]
 - **User Journey Context:** [Links to Mural journey maps or service blueprints]
 - **Success Metrics:** [From Epic - how will we measure success?]
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User Experience

Owner: Product Designer **Contributors:** PM (user perspective), Engineering (technical constraints)

Instructions: Document the user-facing design decisions and flows. Include links to Figma with written rationale for key decisions.

User Flows

[Describe the happy path and key user flows]

UI/UX Decisions

[Document key design decisions and rationale]

- **Figma Links:** [Link to design files]
- [Design decision 1 and why]
- [Design decision 2 and why]

Interaction Patterns & States

- **Loading states:** [How do we show loading?]
- **Error states:** [How do we handle errors?]
- **Empty states:** [What do users see when there's no data?]
- **Success states:** [How do we confirm success?]

Accessibility Considerations

- **WCAG Compliance:** [Any specific requirements?]
- **Screen Reader Support:** [Key considerations]
- **Keyboard Navigation:** [Tab order, shortcuts, focus management]
- **Color Contrast:** [Any special considerations?]

Edge Cases (User Perspective)

[Document edge cases from the user's point of view]

Technical Approach

Owner: Engineering Lead **Contributors:** Design (technical questions/constraints), PM (scope clarification)

Instructions: Document the technical architecture and implementation approach. This is the blueprint engineers will follow.

Architecture Overview

[High-level architecture diagram or description]

Component Breakdown

[List major components, modules, or services]

- **Component 1:** [Purpose, responsibilities]
- **Component 2:** [Purpose, responsibilities]

Data Models & Schemas

[Document data structures, database schemas, or state shape]

```
Example:
{
  "userId": "string",
  "exportFormat": "csv" | "json",
  "createdAt": "timestamp"
}
```

API Contracts

[Document endpoints, request/response formats]

Endpoint: `POST /api/exports` **Request:**

```
{
  "format": "csv",
```

```
"filters": {...}
}
```

Response:

```
{
  "exportId": "string",
  "status": "pending" | "processing" | "complete"
}
```

Integration Points & Dependencies

[External services, APIs, libraries, or other systems this depends on]

Technology Choices & Rationale

[Why did we choose specific technologies or approaches?]

Performance Considerations

[Load time expectations, optimization strategies, caching]

Security Considerations

[Authentication, authorization, data validation, sensitive data handling]

Acceptance Criteria

Owner: Shared (PM drafts, Design & Engineering refine)

Instructions: Detailed, testable criteria. Start with PM's business criteria, then add Design and Engineering details.

Functional Requirements

- ☐ [Criterion 1 - specific and testable]
- ☐ [Criterion 2 - specific and testable]
- ☐ [Criterion 3 - specific and testable]

Edge Cases & Error Handling

- ☐ [How does system handle edge case 1?]
- ☐ [How does system handle error condition 2?]

Performance Requirements

- ☐ [Load time < X seconds]
- ☐ [Can handle Y concurrent users]

Accessibility Requirements

- ☐ [Keyboard navigable]
- ☐ [Screen reader compatible]
- ☐ [WCAG 2.1 AA compliant]

Browser/Device Support

- ☐ [Chrome, Firefox, Safari (latest 2 versions)]
- ☐ [iOS Safari, Chrome mobile]
- ☐ [Responsive design: mobile, tablet, desktop]

Testing Strategy

Owner: Engineering Contributors: PM (user scenarios), Design (visual/interaction QA)

Instructions: How will we verify this works correctly?

Unit Test Coverage

[Which components/functions need unit tests? What's the coverage goal?]

Integration Test Scenarios

[What integration points need testing?]

- ☐ [Scenario 1]
- ☐ [Scenario 2]

Manual QA Focus Areas

[What should QA specifically test?]

- ☐ [Focus area 1]
- ☐ [Focus area 2]

User Acceptance Testing (UAT)

[How will PM/Design validate the implementation?]

Performance Testing

[Load testing, stress testing, benchmarking needs]

Implementation Plan (Optional)

Owner: Engineering

Instructions: How will we break this down and sequence the work?

Phasing Strategy

[If breaking into multiple PRs, describe the phases]

- **Phase 1:** [Scope]
- **Phase 2:** [Scope]

Dependencies & Sequencing

[What needs to happen first? What can run in parallel?]

Estimated Effort

[T-shirt sizing or story points - optional]

Feature Flags or Rollout Strategy

[Gradual rollout? Beta users first? Feature flag approach?]

Open Questions

Owner: Shared (anyone can add, team resolves together)

Instructions: Document unresolved decisions or blockers. This section should be empty before status changes to "Approved".

- ☐ **Question 1:** [What needs to be decided?]
 - **Context:** [Why is this important?]
 - **Options:** [What are we considering?]
 - **Decision:** [To be filled when resolved]
 - ☐ **Question 2:** [What needs validation?]
 - **Risk:** [What's the risk if we get this wrong?]
 - **Mitigation:** [How will we validate or reduce risk?]
-

References

Owner: Shared

Instructions: Consolidate all relevant links and prior work.

Design & Research

- [Figma: Link to design files]
- [Mural: Link to journey maps or service blueprints]
- [Dovetail: Link to research findings]

Documentation

- [Confluence: Link to discovery docs]
- [Related Spec: Link to related spec files if applicable]

Technical Resources

- [API Documentation]
- [Library/Framework docs]
- [Architectural Decision Records (ADRs)]

Revision History

Date	Author	Changes
YYYY-MM-DD	[Name]	Initial draft
YYYY-MM-DD	[Name]	Added UX section
YYYY-MM-DD	[Name]	Technical review updates

Approval Sign-Off

Product Manager: [Name] - [Date] - [Approved/Pending] **Product Designer:** [Name] - [Date] - [Approved/Pending] **Engineering Lead:** [Name] - [Date] - [Approved/Pending]

Once all roles approve, change Status to "Approved" and begin implementation.

Navigation

Getting Started: [Team README](#) · [Spec Template](#) · [Example Spec](#)

Guides: [Status Tracking](#) · [AI Integration](#) · [Pilot Discussion](#)

Framework: [Design Document](#) · [CLAUDE.md](#)